

Security: Preventing Over-Posting / Mass Assignment

- **Scenario:** You have an User entity with sensitive properties like IsAdmin, PasswordHash, or Role.
 - **Risk:** If you bind the entity directly to your form ([Bind] to the entity), a malicious user could tamper with the posted form (e.g., add IsAdmin=true) and escalate privileges.
 - **Solution:**
 - Create a ViewModel that exposes only the fields that should be editable (e.g., Name, Email).
 - Map this ViewModel to your entity in the controller/service layer.
 - **Benefit:** Strongly protects against mass-assignment attacks.
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Combining Data from Multiple Sources

- **Scenario:** A “Product Details” page needs product info, a list of reviews, and the current user’s cart status.
 - **Issue:** The data comes from different tables or services (Product, Review, Cart).
 - **Solution:**
 - Create a ProductDetailsViewModel containing properties like Product, IEnumerable<Review>, and bool IsInCart.
 - Pass this single object to the view instead of multiple unrelated models.
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Formatting / Transforming Data for the View

- **Scenario:** Your domain model stores DateTime in UTC and price as decimal, but the UI needs:
 - Localized date/time strings
 - Currency formatted according to the user’s culture
- **Solution:**
 - ViewModel includes already-formatted strings (DisplayDate, FormattedPrice).
 - Keeps formatting logic out of the view and entity.